

this special quality not found in any other mitzvah

Meaning – Tefillin also draws down the higher level of light from G-d's Intellect into the world of emotion

This is why we desire to constantly study Torah: Torah study surpasses all of creation.

But since we cannot learn Torah all the time, G-d tells us to put on Tefillin.

Therefore the Tefillin which is placed on the head has straps flowing down to our heart.

Tefillin is also placed on the arm near the heart.

We are connecting and revealing the light of intellect to the light of emotion in the action of Tefillin.

And as we mentioned before that we do a Mitzvah G-d does the Mitzvah too. When we put on tefillin, G-d puts on tefillin too.

And G-d's tefillin has a similar effect as Torah study:

G-d putting Tefillin is G-d emanating His light of intellect down into His emotions, the physical world below.

This teaches us how special it is to put on Tefillin, because it accomplishes similar things in the world as if you would have been studying Torah day and night.

However, remember that nothing can totally replace Torah study.

So when you have a moment, Study some Torah, it's the real thing

Check out these study options

www.Chabad.org

www.myJLI.org

www.Jnet.org

www.AskMoses.org

www.RabbiWarwick.com

www.tefillin.net

Maamar Chasidic Discourse Delivered by the Bar Mitzvah.

This Chasidic Discourse was first delivered by the fifth Lubavitcher Rebbe, at his bar mitzvah in 1873.

It was also delivered by the sixth Rebbe, Rabbi Yosef Y. Schneerson at his bar mitzvah on the 12th of Tammuz in 1893.

The discourse explains how both the Mitzvah of putting on Tefillin and the mitzvah of studying Torah can accomplish the same thing.

Joshua 1:8 states "the Torah shall not depart from your mouth. Rather, you should contemplate it day and night in order to observe and do according to all that is written in it."

Psalms 1:1-3 states "and in God's Torah he meditates day and night. He shall be like a tree planted by streams of water, that yields its fruit in its season"

In the Midrash on Tehillim, it is written:

The Jewish people told God, "we wish to study Torah day and at night, but we don't have sufficient time."

God replied, "Fulfill the Mitzvah of Tefillin, and I will consider it as if you had studied Torah day and night."

What are Tefillin?

Jewish Men over the age of Bar Mitzvah put on tefillin daily except for Shabbat and Biblical Jewish holidays.

Inside the tefillin are scrolls of parchment with the Shema prayer and more.

These passages include the Shema and the exodus from Egypt.

This reminds us that G-d is one, and that He has power over all.

We place them on the head and the arm (opposite the heart), which reminds us to dedicate our thoughts, emotions and actions to G-d.

Question: What is the connection between Tefillin and the Learning of Torah?

How is tefillin a substitute for learning Torah?

What is the connection between tefillin and Torah that allows one to take the place of the other?

To answer this question, first we must understand the effect of a mitzvah.

The Effect of a Mitzvah

Every Mitzvah act we perform on earth elicits a reaction from on high.

When we do a mitzvah, G-d “reacts” by doing the same (on a spiritual level).

Our sages phrase it this way: When we do a mitzvah, we “cause” G-d Himself to “do” that mitzvah.

G-d’s mitzvah differs from ours because G-d is not physical. Yet the spiritual content of both mitzvahs is similar.

So when we put on tefillin, we cause G-d to “put on” tefillin.

Now inside our tefillin it is written, “Hear O Israel, the Lord is our G-d, the Lord is ONE.” Praising the greatness of God

What is written in G-d’s Tefillin?

In G-d’s tefillin it is written, “And who is like Your people Israel, ONE nation on earth.” I.E. Praising the greatness of the Jewish people

What is the greatness of the Jewish people?

Our greatness lies in our ability to bring down and permeate the word with the Supernal G-dly “light” and elevate the physical reality with G-d’s inner light.

There are many levels to God’s light.

The External level came along with the creation of the world

And a greater more Inner light is brought down and revealed by the Jewish people when they study the Torah

We can understand this by way of an analogy:

When a person sleeps, we only see a sleeping physical body, and not the mind, which during sleep rises above and ascends to its source.

So too the G-dly light comes into this world in a manner of sleep:

Namely, the light of G-d is not discernable; rather it is like a sleeping person, we only see G-d’s external light.

The greatness of the Jewish people is their ability, thru the study of Torah, to draw down and reveal this Supernal G-dly light into every corner of this physical world.

What is the greatness of Torah that through it we are able to draw down G=d’s Supernal light into the physical world?

The answer is:

The root of Torah is higher than the root of the world.

The root of Torah is Intellect (Understanding)

The root of the physical world is Emotion (feeling)

What is the difference between Intellect and emotion?

Intellect does not require another person. Even when one is alone, without someone with whom to share an idea, it is possible to think intellectually.

The emotions, by contrast, require a recipient e.g. the attribute of kindness requires someone to receive one’s generosity and kindness.

The G-dly light that come naturally into the physical world, it is on a level of emotion, not intellect.

As it is taught, that one of the reasons for why God created the physical world was to be kind to his creations.

The Torah however, being the intellect level light of God, does not come automatically into the physical world.

Through studying Torah, which is the Intellect of G-d, a Jew draws down this great G-dly light into the our physical world.

The mitzvah of Tefillin is EQUAL to the learning of Torah, insofar as it also has